

EVIDENCE • CANVAS • SERIES

word-cloud

Spiral-packed word cloud — items sized by weight.

Weight is meaning in a word cloud.



SIZE = FREQUENCY

more

A

A

a

less

constellation scatters the words like stars.

substance **function**

component

gallery

form **manifest**

SIZE = FREQUENCY

more

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less

dense packs the cloud tight.



SIZE = FREQUENCY

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spectrum colors the words along a scale.

function substance
universal
gallery
component
variant form manifest

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focal crowns one word the center.



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Stress test — 20 terms, raw frequency counts (512 → 5).



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When NOT to reach for word-cloud.

Precise comparisons

If the audience needs to know that 'manifest' is 1.6× 'function', the spiral packing actively misleads. Use `progress` or a bar chart where the eye can compare lengths directly.

Two or three words

A three-word cloud is a list with extra steps. Use `stats` for a metric row or `big-number` for a single weighted headline.

Multi-word phrases

Each li should be a single token. Multi-word phrases blow out the layout and crowd the spiral; if your data is phrases, normalise to keywords first or use `quote` for verbatim text.

RELATED COMPONENTS

See also.

`progress` — the weights need precise visual comparison

`stats` — the headline metrics are independent numbers,
not a corpus

`piechart` — the items are parts of a whole, not free-form
themes

`quote` — the verbatim language matters more than the
frequency

`list` — single-line takeaways — the `takeaway` variant